COMMERCIAL HYPOTHESES

A focused layer for OT vulnerability assurance

Potential users span small operators, contractors, and managed OT security providers. This is a customer discovery plan, not a market-size estimate.

Who may buy or champion

Municipal water and wastewater utilities; power and energy operators; oil and gas infrastructure; industrial maintenance contractors; managed OT security providers; and defense-support facilities. Likely champions include an OT security lead, plant engineering manager, asset owner, CISO, or managed-service practice owner.

Position relative to existing products

Public product pages describe mature OT platforms and GRC/IRM workflows. OTProof is not positioned as a proven replacement. Its hypothesis is a small source-linked reconciliation workflow that may complement existing discovery, vulnerability, CMMS, and audit systems.

Category	Publicly described capability	OTProof implication
Claroty	CPS asset inventory, exposure management, network protection, secure access, threat detection.	Competes for broad OT platform budgets; possible data/workflow integration.
Tenable	OT inventory, exposure prioritization, remediation guidance, integrations, compliance reporting.	Broad incumbent; MVP has no coverage or accuracy advantage claim.
Nozomi	Asset discovery, firmware details, vulnerability assessment, network visibility.	Potential integration target; no comparative test run.
GRC / IRM	Risk assessment, control, compliance, and audit workflow, e.g. ServiceNow.	Potential downstream system of record; integration is future work.

Differentiation hypothesis

OTProof emphasizes exact inventory/advisory evidence, conservative abstention when the source or inventory is incomplete, and a human assurance trail in one narrow workflow. Existing platforms may already solve the buyer's problem. Interviews and integration trials must establish whether a distinct product is useful.

Evidence to test: product coverage, engineer agreement, false negatives, abstention quality, review minutes per pair, onboarding effort, integration demand, willingness to pay, and renewal interest.

ILLUSTRATIVE UNIT ECONOMICS

Recurring site license with paid implementation

A transparent first model makes the assumptions easy to challenge before a commercial forecast is attempted.

Scenario inputs

3 licensed sites per customer; $36,000 annual license per site; $25,000 one-time onboarding per new customer; 78% software gross margin; 40% onboarding-services gross margin. Year-1 revenue equals recurring ARR plus onboarding. Gross profit equals recurring ARR x 78% plus onboarding x 40%.

Customers	Sites	Recurring ARR	Year-1 revenue	Year-1 gross profit
1	3	$108,000	$133,000	$94,240
5	15	$540,000	$665,000	$471,200
10	30	$1,080,000	$1,330,000	$942,400
25	75	$2,700,000	$3,325,000	$2,356,000

Illustrative arithmetic only. The scenarios are not customer commitments, an addressable-market calculation, bookings, or a revenue forecast. No revenue has been generated by this MVP.

Potential contract structure

Annual per-site subscription; enterprise tier for multi-site operators; integration and deployment fees; and optional ongoing assurance services. A local/on-premises deployment option may matter for sensitive inventories. Each component needs cost and procurement validation.

Illustrative labor sensitivity, not measured savings

Assume 80 assets, 12 relevant asset/advisory pairs per year, and a reduction from 30 to 15 minutes of initial triage per pair. That yields 240 theoretical hours, or $19,200 at an assumed $80 loaded hourly rate. This excludes engineering remediation effort and assumes every pair realizes the time reduction; the MVP has no human time study.

GO-TO-MARKET AND VALIDATION

Sell a measurable workflow improvement, not an AI promise

A controlled design-partner pilot should prove that the tool fits plant roles, records, and approval practices before product expansion.

Commercial route

Begin with 3-5 design partners from water, energy, industrial maintenance, or managed OT security. Offer an on-premises or isolated IT deployment for approved sample inventories. Integrate first with CSV/XLSX, then with a CMMS/GRC system only where pilot users show a recurring need. Sell onboarding as inventory normalization and workflow configuration, not a promise of automated risk removal.

Customer value to measure

Measure review minutes per advisory/asset pair, the number of data gaps found, engineer agreement, false-negative adjudications, abstention rate, evidence completeness, time to export an audit package, onboarding hours, and continued use after the pilot. Potential benefits include less repeated source lookup, clearer audit evidence, and earlier engineering assessment of exposure. Those benefits remain hypotheses until measured; OTProof does not itself establish compliance or reduce operational risk.

Key risks and response

Weak inventory quality can limit results; expose stale/missing data and assign owners. Advisory parsing can miss vendor nuance; preserve source excerpts and abstain. Established products may duplicate capabilities; position as complement and integrate. Sensitive asset information limits cloud adoption; test local deployment. Human review still costs time; quantify actual time saved and false-positive burden. Buyers may reject price; test paid pilots and renewal intent.

Sources and market context

Competitor summaries are based on public vendor pages, not independent product tests: Claroty (claroty.com/platform), Tenable (tenable.com/products/ot-security), Nozomi (technicaldocs.nozominetworks.com/guardian), ServiceNow GRC (servicenow.com/docs). Full linked citations are in docs/RESEARCH_NOTES.md. Pricing, headcount, gross margin, customer conversion, and savings assumptions are illustrative.

Pilot success gate: verified engineering agreement and useful abstentions across multiple vendors, safe deployment acceptance, source traceability, measurable review-time change, and willingness to pay.